

UMBL English Promo Copy (For Reddit Medium X Hacker News)

This file contains three types of English promotional copy designed for Western platforms

- Standard Version for Medium, Reddit long posts
- Short Version for XTwitter, Mastodon, Reddit intros
- One-Sentence Hooks for titles, thumbnails, or post openings

All content is tailored to Western conlang, linguistics, and tech communities.

1. Standard Version (Medium Reddit)

UMBL (Universal Meaning-Based Language) is an ongoing pictographic language-design project.

It is not an icon set, not a UI library, and not a branding system.

UMBL is an attempt to explore what a structured, compositional, evolvable pictographic language could look like if we designed one from scratch.

The project grew out of long-term observations comparing Chinese and English

- Chinese builds meaning through character formation, radicals, and visual structure
- English builds abstraction through roots, affixes, and morphology
- Chinese media culture leans heavily toward visual-semantic expression (subtitles, danmu overlays)
- Phonetic writing systems face challenges in cross-cultural comprehension
- Natural languages are not always consistent in logic, abstraction, or semantic transparency

These observations led to a simple question

If we could redesign a language, could it be both visually intuitive and structurally systematic

UMBL does not claim superiority over existing languages.

It is a language engineering prototype, created to explore

- How to define pictographic morphemes
- How to combine components into words
- How to construct pictographic sentences
- How to design grammar, formation rules, and evolution mechanisms

UMBL is still in an early stage, but it already serves as

- A research object for linguistics, cognitive science, design, and computer science
- A source of undergraduate thesis topics
- A platform for discussing how languages can be engineered, not just inherited

If you're interested in conlangs, visual communication, cross-cultural semantics, or language design as an engineering discipline, UMBL might be worth following.

2. Short Version (X Mastodon Reddit Intro)

UMBL is a developing pictographic constructed language project.
Not an icon set — a language prototype.

Inspired by differences between Chinese and English, UMBL explores whether a language can be

- visually intuitive
- structurally compositional
- and evolution-ready

It's still early, but it's open, experimental, and research-friendly.

If you like conlangs, visual semantics, or language engineering, this project is for you.

3. One-Sentence Hooks (Titles Thumbnails Tweet Openers)

- What if a language could be redesigned from scratch
 - A developing pictographic language UMBL.
 - Not an icon set. A language prototype.
 - Exploring a structured, evolvable pictographic language.
 - Language engineering meets visual semantics.
 - A conlang experiment inspired by Chinese and English.
 - Can a language be both visual and systematic
 - UMBL a research-driven pictographic language project.
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Usage Notes

Choose the version based on platform

- Medium Reddit long posts → Standard Version
- X Mastodon Reddit short posts → Short Version
- Titles thumbnails post headers → One-Sentence Hooks

This file is intended for the Spread folder as part of UMBL's public-facing materials.